

Aya Okizaki

Full Stack Developer

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Summary

Software engineer with 3+ years of experience building scalable backend systems and web applications. Skilled in writing clean, testable code, API design, relational data modeling, and third-party service integration. Brings a collaborative team mindset, strong attention to detail, and a growth-focused approach to every project. Before transitioning into tech, I worked as a baker for over 10 years in Japan and Canada, which built a process-driven approach and care for quality that carries into my engineering work.

Skills

- Languages : JavaScript, TypeScript, Ruby, HTML, CSS, SCSS
- Frameworks : Node.js, React, Vue.js, Express.js, Fastify
- Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Firebase, Supabase, Redis
- DevOps & Tools: AWS, Docker, Git, Prisma, Jest, Stripe, Tailwind CSS, REST APIs

Work Experience

Software Developer | August 2022 - March 2026

Think Tank Training Centre / Vancouver, BC

- Wrote clean, maintainable backend code using **TypeScript**, **Node.js**, and **Prisma**, contributing to a 23% increase in student application submissions through improved accessibility and user flow.
- Built and tested unit and integration tests using **Jest** across backend services and APIs to improve system reliability and catch issues before production.
- Designed and implemented a dynamic requirements engine, reducing scattered conditional logic into a modular, reusable system that improved code maintainability and simplified application validation.
- Collaborated with frontend developers and designers to align API design with product requirements, participating in daily stand-ups, code reviews, and sprint planning.
- Integrated third-party APIs and webhook services to automate data synchronization and event-driven workflows, improving backend reliability and system communication.

Full Stack Software Developer Intern | April 2022 - June 2022

Behavior / United States

- Built a custom data visualization feature in React to display user health metrics from Firebase, enabling users to track recovery progress across multiple dimensions simultaneously.
- Used React Query for data fetching and caching, ensuring graphs showed real-time data with automatic background refreshing.

Volunteer Experience

Software Developer | April 2026 - Present

Murphy Charitable Foundation Uganda / Vancouver, BC

- Contributing to frontend development for a nonprofit website using React and Next.js, working closely with a small team to build and improve the site.
- Set up and configured **Supabase Storage**, including bucket creation, folder structure, and Row Level Security (RLS) policies for managing profile images.
- Built the end-to-end flow for uploading and saving profile images for sponsors and children, connected to a Supabase database

Education

Lighthouse Labs / Full Stack Web Development Bootcamp

January 2022 - April 2022